CLIMATE İMECE

From Climate Action to Implementation with Young People, Educational Institutions and Local Communities

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INTRODUCTION

CLIMATE İMECE: FROM CLIMATE ACTION TO IMPLEMENTATION

A human-centred, collaborative and participatory model for climate action

Built on a method tested in more than 5,000 applications in schools and institutions at every level since 1997, and awarded in the 2005 Türkiye Creative Development Ideas Competition.

COP31 · Antalya 2026

RESEARCH TEAM · Istanbul Kent University

HK — **Prof. Dr. Hayal Köksal**
Project Director

AM — **Res. Asst. Dr. Memet Aslan**
Researcher

ÇA — **Res. Asst. Aleyna Çavdar**
Researcher

KA — **Res. Asst. Azad Kılıçarslan**
Researcher

AS — **Res. Asst. Ayça Selin Akyol**
Researcher

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OUR CENTRAL QUESTION

?

How can we move young people from climate awareness to meaningful climate action?

Young people should become active partners in identifying problems, developing solutions and implementing change.

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THE MODEL

A model that brings education stakeholders together: İMECE CIRCLES!

1. Young people
2. Educational institutions
3. Universities
4. Local communities

Through collaboration and collective action rooted in Turkish culture.

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WHY CLIMATE İMECE?

1. Climate change is a multidimensional global challenge.
2. Information and awareness alone are not sufficient.
3. Local knowledge and academic knowledge need to meet.
4. Young people need opportunities to participate in real solutions.
5. Sustainable change requires collective responsibility.

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WHAT IS İMECE?

A Turkish tradition of collective effort and action

İMECE is a traditional Turkish concept referring to people coming together voluntarily to achieve a shared goal.

In our educational model, İMECE represents:

- Belonging
- Participation
- Collaboration
- Collective Learning
- Collective Intelligence
- Co-creation
- Collective Action
- Quality and Social Impact

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THE POWER OF İMECE

From individual effort to collective intelligence

Young people identifying real problems together

Learning and acting as a community

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WHAT IS AN İMECE CIRCLE?

A small, voluntary and collaborative learning community that follows PDCA, the total quality management (TQM) cycle

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THE PROJECT'S ORIGINAL CONTRIBUTION

From awareness to action

Climate İMECE brings together:

1. Young people's local and experiential knowledge
2. Academic and scientific knowledge
3. Educational institutions
4. Local communities and stakeholders
5. International learning and cooperation networks

THE INNOVATION

Transforming young people from passive learners into active climate solution partners.

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PARTNERS AND INTERNATIONAL COOPERATION

A multi-country learning network

India | Algeria | Türkiye

LEAD INSTITUTION

- Istanbul Kent University, Türkiye

INTERNATIONAL PARTNERS

- Kasdi Merbah University, Algeria
- World Council for Total Quality and Excellence in Education (WCTQEE), 35 countries

- Little Angels High School, Gwalior, India
- Suncity School, Gurgaon, India
- Bhavan Vidyalaya, Panchkula, India
- Gyan Heritage School, Lucknow, India
- & more...

PROJECT RESEARCH TEAM

- Prof. Dr. Hayal Köksal – Project Director
- Dr. Memet Aslan – Researcher
- Aleyna Çavdar – Researcher
- Azad Kılıçarslan – Researcher
- Ayça Selin Akyol – Researcher

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MAIN AIM AND OBJECTIVES

Our main aim

To develop a practical Climate İMECE model that enables young people to:

3 KEY QUESTIONS: What is our problem? Why does it exist? How do we solve it?

1	2	3	4	5
Identify climate challenges in their own environments	**Combine** local and global academic knowledge	**Develop** collaborative and sustainable solutions	**Implement** small-scale pilot actions	**Evaluate** and spread the results by sharing them

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MAIN AIM AND OBJECTIVES

Specific objectives

1. Establish a pilot Climate İMECE application at Istanbul Kent University.
2. Create collaborative İMECE Circles.
3. Identify climate problems and their causes, and develop at least three applicable climate solutions.
4. Encourage international learning between Türkiye, Algeria and India, and inspire other countries to join.
5. Prepare a practical implementation guide and keep improving it to ensure continuity.
6. Keep going with encouraging, sharing-based methods so the model can be transferred to other institutions and communities.

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METHODOLOGY: İMECE CIRCLES AND PDCA

A participatory and action-oriented research model

The project integrates İMECE Circles with the PDCA mindset, the quality improvement cycle:

PLAN

P

Identify problems, determine their causes after a literature review and plan solutions. Do all this using quality tools and AI ethically.

DO

D

Implement selected actions through pilot studies.

CHECK

C

Monitor and evaluate results.

ACT

A

Improve, adapt and share successful practices. Make this process continuous!

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THE RESEARCH PROCESS

Four work (implementation) packages (WPs)

WP1

Preparation

- Form teams of volunteers by area of interest
- Review the literature
- Use quality tools ethically and effectively

WP2

İMECE Circles

- Identifying and confirming local climate challenges
- Defining common problem areas
- Finding main and root causes, and a solution for each, through collaborative discussion

WP3

International Collaborative Learning

- Online meetings
- Sharing local experiences
- Comparing climate challenges

WP4

Joint Solutions and Pilot Actions

- Developing solutions
- Implementing selected actions
- Evaluating, reporting and sharing results
- Sustainability matters

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RESEARCH AND EVALUATION

How will we measure progress?

Three main sources of evidence

- Initial and final assessment forms, including peer and jury assessment
- İMECE process records
- Participant reflections and evaluations

Data analysis

- Frequencies, percentages and averages
- Comparison of initial and final assessments
- Thematic analysis of qualitative data

Key areas of evaluation

- Climate awareness
- Participation in climate action
- Collaboration
- Collective problem-solving
- Confidence in implementing solutions
- Ensuring sustainability and measurability

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EXPECTED OUTPUTS AND IMPACT

From local solutions to international learning

1. A Climate İMECE Youth Model
2. At least three climate solutions developed by young people
3. Pilot implementation activities
4. A practical Climate İMECE Implementation Guide
5. An International Youth Climate Learning Network
6. A digital archive documenting experiences and solutions
7. At least one scientific paper or conference presentation
8. Outputs shared on the web and across all digital channels

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FROM LOCAL ACTION TO GLOBAL CONTRIBUTION

Our vision

1. Empowering young people
2. Connecting local and scientific knowledge
3. Encouraging international cooperation
4. Supporting sustainable educational practices
5. Building a culture of shared responsibility

> **Climate action begins locally; its impact embraces the whole world.**

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CONCLUSION

Climate İMECE: learning together, acting together

We believe that:

1. Young people are not merely the future; they are partners in today's climate action.
2. Education should lead to meaningful action.
3. Collaboration transforms individual knowledge into collective intelligence.
4. Quality improvement makes action measurable and sustainable.
5. İMECE creates opportunities for people to work together for a better future.

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OUR GUIDING PRINCIPLE

Compete with Yourself,

Collaborate with Others.

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THANK YOU

Today, I am presenting this research project on behalf of Istanbul Kent University and our international project partners. The more countries stand with us, the faster the impact. We look forward to having you with us.

Compete with Yourself, Collaborate with Others.

Prof. Dr. Hayal Köksal
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